

Small Office Network & Security Checklist

Provided by NK Tech Solutions — nktechphilly.com — (267) 225-8237

This checklist covers the 10 most common network and security gaps found in small professional offices. Use it to assess your current setup. Each item marked NO or UNSURE represents a potential risk to your business operations, data security, and compliance.

1. Business-Grade Router

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

Do you have a business-grade router (not the one your ISP provided or a consumer device from Best Buy)?

Why it matters: Consumer routers can't handle simultaneous VoIP, EHR software, and multiple staff devices under load.

2. Firewall Enabled & Configured

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

Is a firewall active and properly configured — not just the default out-of-the-box settings?

Why it matters: Default firewall settings leave most ports open. A configured firewall blocks unauthorized access.

3. Separate Guest Wi-Fi Network

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

Do you have a separate Wi-Fi network for guests, patients, or clients?

Why it matters: Mixing guest and staff traffic on one network exposes internal systems and violates HIPAA segmentation requirements.

4. Strong Wi-Fi Encryption

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

Is your Wi-Fi using WPA3 or WPA2 encryption — not WEP or an open network?

Why it matters: Outdated or absent encryption allows anyone nearby to intercept network traffic.

5. Regular Password Changes

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

Are Wi-Fi passwords and network device passwords changed at least every 90 days?

Why it matters: Default or unchanged passwords are the most common entry point for unauthorized access.

6. VoIP on a Dedicated Network

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

If you use VoIP phones, are they on a dedicated VLAN or network segment?

Why it matters: Shared VoIP traffic causes call quality issues and creates security vulnerabilities.

7. Remote Access Is Secured

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

If staff access the office network remotely, is it through a VPN — not just a shared password?

Why it matters: Unsecured remote access is one of the top vectors for ransomware and data breaches.

8. Network Monitoring in Place

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

Does anyone proactively monitor your network for outages, unusual activity, or performance issues?

Why it matters: Without monitoring, you find out about problems when patients or clients do.

9. Data Backup Is Tested

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

Are your critical files and systems backed up, and has the restore process been tested in the last 6 months?

Why it matters: An untested backup is not a reliable backup. Ransomware recovery depends on this.

10. Security Assessment on File

☐ YES

☐ NO

☐ UNSURE

Has your network had a documented security assessment in the last 12 months?

Why it matters: For HIPAA-covered entities, documented assessments are a compliance requirement, not a suggestion.

Not sure where your office stands?

NK Tech Solutions offers a free 15-minute network assessment for small offices in the Philadelphia metro area. No obligation. No sales pitch. Just an honest assessment from someone with 10+ years on the ISP side of enterprise telecom. (267) 225-8237 · nazaam@nktechphilly.com · nktechphilly.com